

# Lab 09 — Restoration, Critique and Colour Strategy

**Course:** Generative AI for Adobe Photoshop (C16) **Version:** v7 · 21 August 2026

## Scenario

An archive image will support a heritage-wellness story but must not imply certainty where AI reconstructs missing detail.

## Objective

Restore a damaged image, evaluate invented detail and develop a reversible colour treatment.

## Supplied Photoshop/JPEG files

- colour-reference.jpeg
- old-damaged-image-start.psd

## Detailed procedure

1. Open the damaged PSD and save lab09-restoration.psd without altering the original layer.
2. Use a Neural Filter or restoration workflow with output set to a new layer.
3. Inspect faces, hands, edges and repeating texture; mask or retouch unsupported artefacts.
4. Create a Levels or Curves adjustment layer to establish usable tonal range without clipping.
5. Develop a restrained palette using Colour Balance or Hue/Saturation adjustment layers and masks.
6. Compare the original, AI-only and corrected states at Fit and 100%.
7. Write a critique distinguishing observed source detail from AI-inferred detail.
8. Export lab09-final.jpg and retain a palette swatch layer in the PSD.

## Evidence to retain

Layered restoration PSD, verified JPEG, palette swatches and critique of AI-inferred detail.

## Acceptance criteria

- ☐ Original, AI output and manual corrections remain separately reviewable.
- ☐ Tonal range avoids unintended highlight/shadow clipping.
- ☐ The critique discloses uncertainty and proposes a defensible enhancement.

## **Reflection prompts**

- Which decision most improved the message or focal hierarchy?
- How does the Layers panel prove that the workflow remains editable?
- What rights or provenance evidence must accompany the finished image?